GOD'S KIND OF LEADER

The
Righteous & Responsible
Man

By
Dr. C.C. Mbadinuju

God's Kind of Leader

First Edition 1988

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FORWARD

The Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation (CMF) presents a reprint of this book, first published in 1988: **"God's Kind of Leader – A Righteous and Responsible Man"**, to commemorate the State Burial of its author, my father and our founding Principal, His Excellency, Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera 1 of Uli) who passed away in April 2023.

Dr Chinwoke Mbadinuju is best remembered as the Executive Governor of Anambra State between 1999-2003. Before 1999, he had distinguished himself as an erudite Scholar, Academic, Lawyer, Journalist, Presidential assistant, Evangelist, Community leader and Author/Publisher of several Political and Christian Literature. He was also a practicing born again Christian, determined to follow the ways of his God to the exclusion of his personal preferences.

In this seminal book, Mbadinuju explores the concept of a Righteous and Responsible Leadership subsumed in Godly directions as it relates to the kind of leadership Nigeria requires in a democratic dispensation, emphasizing that such leadership was the only panacea to development and prosperity in the Nation. The Author attempts to reconcile his Christianity with the need to provide purposeful leadership

for the benefit of Nigerians, critically analyzing the lingering premonition among Christians in Nigeria that Politics generally was far too dirty a pre-occupation which would contaminate even the most upright.

Though written before the advent of the 3rd Republic and 11 years before Dr Mbadinuju was sworn in as the Anambra State Governor, the book remains relevant today as it highlights the irreconcilable challenges a righteous and responsible Leader would face in seeking for elective office in Nigeria, and the inevitable frustrations and travails he would encounter in the course of his public service.

Perhaps, and in conjunction with Dr Mbadinuju's memoirs, this book will be effective where it aids discerning readers in understanding the Author's motivations and frame of mind as he maneuvered the process to become the State Governor and as State Governor, when confronted with the diabolical challenges and intrigues that plagued his Administration between 1999-2003. Remain blessed as you read.

Cheta Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Esq.
Principal Curator
Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation
November, 2023

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1

INTRODUCTION
DEFINITIONS OF TERMS

Chairman and Distinguished Guests, it is a privilege for me to be given a chance to contribute a few ideas on a subject as wide, but crucially important and provocative as "The Transition Programme - Search for Righteous and Responsible Leadership."

It seems to me that almost every word in this topic from "Transitional Programme" to "Righteous", to "Responsible", and even " Leadership" would need to be defined or explained not only for the interest of the legal minds but also for the "common man" on the street (borrowing from one of the letters of Mr Tony Momoh, Minister of Information to his fellow "Nigerian").

However, for the purpose of keeping my comment as brief as possible, I have chosen to define just the two key words in the topic which adequately qualify the kind of leadership the country should aim at in the transitional arrangement. I have in mind the words, "righteous" and "responsible".

Collins Gem English dictionary and Webster's Home University Dictionary defined "righteous" as just, upright, godly venture, good, honest, equitable, ruled by what is right, blameless, for example a righteous man, a righteous cause, a righteous anger. The word also means pious, guiltless, pure. The opposite of righteousness is evil, sinful, immoral and unholy.

Furthermore, both dictionaries defined "responsible" as liable to answer for, accountable; of good credit or position; answerable, as you are 'responsible' to the law, fit to be trusted with the carrying out of a charge or duty; able and ready to meet obligations. When we combine the above qualities of "righteousness" with those of "responsibility" it would amount to the qualities of leaders and leadership which Nigerians should expect from aspirants to public and political office in the Third Republic.

2

IS THERE A RIGHTEOUS NIGERIAN?

The next million-naira question is how and where we can find such combination of virtues and qualities in Nigeria today? The task, therefore, before this Conference is not only to make a case for righteous and responsible leadership but actually to say if it is possible to have in Nigeria today, a just, upright, godly, virtuous, good, honest, equitable, blameless, pious, guiltless, pure, and accountable, liable, answerable, trusted, able, ready, willing, righteous, and responsible man who will be the leader.

I do not know how many people in this hall who can just volunteer themselves as such leaders so that our search can be over. I am convinced, however, that in such a large gathering of Christian lawyers from all over the country as we have here today, that the search for the kind of leadership we are talking about ought to start from here. It ought to start with ourselves and among ourselves. If Christian lawyers in Nigeria, or indeed anywhere, cannot produce righteous and responsible leadership then we know we are failing in our calling.

The next question to tackle is this: can a man living be righteous or holy? Is it possible in this life to be holy, to be perfect, without spot, upright and blameless? For if we know it is not possible, then there would be no need searching.

First of all, we are told in the word of God that no one is good. In Psalm 14:2-3 we are told that "the Lord looked down from heaven upon the children of men, to see if there were any that did understand, and seek God. They are all gone astray they have all together become filthy: there is none that doeth good, no, not one"

But if Psalm 14 belongs to Old Testament, let us look at Romans 3:10-12. It says that, "there is none righteous, no not one. There is none that understandeth, there is none that seeketh after God. They are all gone out of the way, they are together become unprofitable; there is none that doeth good, no, not one." This is God's verdict upon all men after the fall of Adam. All men inherited the sin of Adam, and since "the wages of sin is death", all men are therefore dead in sin. However, we are also told that "the gift of God is eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord"(Romans 6:23).

Although every man has fallen and become a sinner, and therefore all deserved death, but the Word of God says that God is "Long suffering to us, not willing that any should perish, but that all should come to repentance" (2 Peter 3:9).

Repentance in this case means turning away from our evil and sinful ways and believing in the Son of God, as our Lord and personal Savior. The Bible says that "he that haththe Son hath life; and he hath not the Son of God hath not life. (1 john 5:12)

But someone may ask, what does having the son of God, or not having Him got to do with righteousness? Well, it has everything to do with it because there is only one man who is righteous in this whole world, and that man is the Lord Jesus Christ. God made Him "to be sin for us, who knew no sin; that we might be made the righteousness of God in him" (2 Cor 5:21). And holiness in imputed to us after we believe in Him and dedicate ourselves to living His life (Romans 4:24). For the Lord says, "Be ye therefore perfect, even as your Father which is in heaven is perfect" (Matt 5:48); and in 1 Peter 1:16, he said, "Be ye holy for I am holy."

If it is not possible for us to be the perfect and holy now in this life, the Lord will not command it; and furthermore, he says that "without holiness no man should see the Lord " (Hebrews 12:14). So, it is possible to be holy in this life and some have been made righteous because of the righteousness of another man, the Lord Jesus Christ. It is only in Christ that a man can become righteous, holy, pure blameless, honest, godly, upright, pious and guiltless. In other words, a man is

righteous or holy because he has received Jesus Christ as his Lord and personal Savior (2 Cor 5:21). It means also that no man alive can be righteous or holy on his own effort or account or by the work of his own hand. The word of God says that every man is as an unclean thing and all our righteousness are as filthy rags"(Isaiah 64:6).

We therefore say at this stage that without Christ, none can be righteous. Christ said without me you can do nothing"(John 15:5). Without Christ, no one can be pure, blameless, holy, pious, guiltless, or righteous. It seems proper, therefore, that in our search for the righteous leadership will of necessity take us back to the righteous Lord and them who are made righteous in Him.

It is our belief and faith that Christ is the only righteous man who ever lived on this earth. On the other hand, all men have sinned and come short of the glory of God (Rom 6:23). All are therefore dead because the wages of sin is death (Rom 6:23). But it is not the will of God that any should perish (2 Peter 3:9). Therefore, God so loved us that he gave his only begotten son that whosoever believeth in him shall not perish but have everlasting life (John 3:16). This, in effect, means that "the gift of God is eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord"(Romans 6:23). If you believe in Him, you are not condemned, "but he that believeth not is condemned already because he hath not believed in the name of the only begotten son of God"(John 3:18).

3

SHOULD A POLITICAL LEADER BE RIGHTEOUS?

Now that we have known what righteous means, is it required that a political leader should be righteous or holy or blameless? Are we not importing religion into politics by expecting our leaders to be pious and perfect? I know some people would ask some questions. But who says that politics and government should be the devil's work? Why should politics be a dirty game and remain a dirty game? Why should not holy men of God like Daniel be in government? Why should fraudulent men, deceitful men, liars' nepotists, tribalists and looters be the right people to rule? Why should not honest, truthful and regenerated men of God rule so that our people may rejoice?

I pointed out in my earlier book on “Law and Religion in Nigeria” that the Constitution forbids the government from adopting any region as State religion. However, “in making the country a secular state, the Constitution did not make it a Godless nation"(P. 16). The leaders of this nation have hidden themselves behind the secular status of the country to commit many ungodly acts. This country should now require

that their leaders should be righteous, God-fearing, honest and blameless. These are not religious attributes; they are attributes of God. We are not asking our leaders to be religious; we are asking that they reflect the character of God in their life, in their handling of the affairs of the nation.

We should not prefer robbers to rule us neither should we pray for the devil to rule us. If we have any choice, I will prefer to be ruled by God or anybody with the life of God in him, a righteous man, a man who will tell me the nation has N5,000.00 and I believe him because it will not later turn out to be N1,000.00. A man who will make a law and not break the law himself. A man who when he says, "I am coming", will not be seen "going". That's the type of ruler or leader I look forward to in the Third Republic. So far, we have not gotten such leaders in the history of this nation. Some have been decent leaders, but none was righteous.

4

TWO ASPECTS OF RESPONSIBILITY

As we now turn our attention to "responsible" leadership, the question that immediately comes to mind is responsible to whom? When a few years back we studied the British Constitution for the GCE examination, we were taught that the British Cabinet was both a representative and a responsible Government. The Government was "representative" of all British people while the Cabinet was responsible to the Parliament. As a responsible Cabinet, it rises or falls together. If one Minister is defeated in a debate or in a vote in the Parliament, then all the Ministers resign and the Government falls. Therefore, when one Minister is in trouble all other Ministers rally around him because if they leave him to fall, he would drag every other person along. I do not know whether they still practice the system because it is now common to ask a misbehaved Minister to just resign, or the Prime Minister could remove him in order to save others.

However, when we say that we are searching for a responsible leadership, I see two aspects of it: One is responsibility to the people being led, and the other perhaps more important is

responsibility to God. Almost all the leaders we have had in this country as well as the successive Governments at all levels of the Federation have at one time or the other functioned or operated as if they were responsible to no one, including even those on whose back they rode to power. There has almost been a complete lack of accountability and responsibility of leaders to the led. And few leaders have ever thought that they owe any responsibility to God in the discharge of their public functions.

5

RESPONSIBILITY IS TO GOD

One of the reasons our leaders do not generally feel responsible to God is because they feel they got to power without Him. And it makes sense because if the leaders rig themselves into power, why would they owe any responsibility to the electorate, and why would they hold themselves accountable to God? They therefore behave without restraint when once they succeed to maneuver themselves into rulership or leadership positions.

But it should now be clear that a righteous leader must be a responsible leader; responsible to God first and responsible to his people. In other words, the responsibility of righteous leader is first to God, and secondly to the people he leads. If the interest of the people clashes with the will of God, the righteous leader must first carry out God's Will. In fact, people's interest should never be attended to If they conflict with the will of God. Someone may update and quote our lord's injunction a Mark 12:17, that we should render to Caesar' the things that are Caesar's, and to God the things that are God's"

But what if, for example, the political party wants the leaders to charge 10 per cent on all government contracts in order to enrich the party's fund? And you know that 10 per cent charge on contracts is bribery and a sin, because God said that “the congregation of hypocrites shall be desolate, and fire should consume the tabernacle of bribery" (Job 15:34). What will the leader do? If he does not deduct 10 per cent, his party will jettison him. If it takes the bribe God will destroy him. Does he please the people or please God? Our leaders so far have pleased people rather than God in cases like this.

But look at the earlier disciples of our Lord, when they were faced with similar choice of whether to obey men or God (Acts 5:29), they declared: “we ought to obey God rather than men." And let me say that whenever you choose to obey God instead of men, you will suffer in the hands of men. Even the disciple suffered (Acts 5:40). But notice their reaction in verse 41 " And they departed from the presence of the council, rejoicing that they were counted worthy to suffer shame for His name."

If you suffer because of His name, because you want to live a righteous life, the life of Christ, and they remove you from office, or they refuse to nominate you as a candidate, or they speak all sorts of evil against you and call you names falsely, the Lord said, "Rejoice, and be exceedingly glad: ("leap for

joy" Luke 6:23) for great is your reward in heaven: For so persecuted they the prophets which we are before you" (Matt 5:11-12). And remember that those who will live righteously in Christ shall suffer persecution (2 Tim 3:12).

6

FEAR OF MEN

Many leaders live a life of compromise with sin and evil because they fear men. Fear of men is a dangerous thing as well, and is a sin for a righteous leader. You will remember the case of blind man whom the Lord healed in John Chapter 9. The Jews asked the blind man's parents saying: "Is this your son whom ye say was born blind? how then doth he now see? The parents answered "We know that this is our son and that he was born blind but by what means he now seeth, we know not or who hath opened his eyes, we know not: He is of age, ask him, he shall speak for himself.

These words his parents spoke because they feared the Jews for the Jews has agreed already, that if any man did confess that he was Christ, he should be put out of the synagogue" (John 9:19-22). And in John 12: 42-43 we are told that "Among the chief rulers also many believed on Him, but because of the Pharisees, they do not confess Him, lest they should be put out of the synagogue, for they loved the praise of men more than the praise of God."

The major problem in our nation today is this same problem of fear of men. You will know the right thing to do but you would not do it because you are afraid of what this man or the other man will say or do. You are afraid of repercussions. Even today some people change their religion for fear they may lose their jobs working under someone of different religious faith. Some even change their religion in order to win contracts or in order to be considered for some lucrative political posts.

But our Lord says in Luke 12: 4-5 "My friends, be not afraid of them that kill the body and after that have no more that they can do. but I will forewarn you whom ye shall fear: Fear him, which after he hath killed, hath power to cast into hell; yea I say unto you, fear him."

7

ACCOUNTABILITY TO GOD

So, it is only God that righteous leaders should fear. His responsibility is first to God because it is only God who has power to cast one into hell. It is God who will ultimately judge everyone.

We were told in Romans 14:12 that "everyone of us shall give account of himself to God" and God shall surely "render to every man according to his deeds" (Rom 2:6; Gal 6:7) because "there is no respect of persons with God" (Rom 2:11; James 2:1). A leader cannot escape the judgment of God because he is a leader. Rather, we must all appear before God, “that everyone may receive the things done in his body according to that he hath done whether it been good or bad"(2Cor 5:10).

The righteous leader knows that whatever he does is under the scrutiny of the all searching eyes of God and His eyes go to and fro the whole earth" (2 Chronicles 16:9). And we are told further that, "neither is there any creature that is not manifest in his sight but all things are naked and open unto the eyes of

Him with whom we have to do" (Hebrew 4:13). The Lord knows everything, even the intents of our hearts, the hidden things of darkness, and the counsels of the heart (1 Cor 4:5). Even the words in our mouth, before they are formed, the Lord has known them altogether (Psalm 139:4).

So, there is no escape for anyone and that is why the righteous leader is first and foremost responsible and accountable to God because "there is no power but of God; the powers that be are ordained of God" (Romans 3:1). And God as a righteous judge shall judge everyone because He "Hath appointed a day in which he will judge the world in righteousness by that man whom He hath ordained; whereof he hath given assurance unto all men, in that he hath raised him from the dead" (Acts 17:31).

8

A STANDARD FOR NIGERIA

But some people may still object and say that the picture of a righteous and responsible leader presented here is that of a Christian religion. And they may ask, how can it be done in a multi religious country like Nigeria? Let me say, first of all, the picture of a righteous and responsible leadership presented here is a standard one. it is not a standard for just Christians, but it is the standard for the nation. I might say that large majority of those who call themselves Christians cannot even meet with this standard of righteousness and responsibility. It is only those whose Adamic nature has been crucified and buried, and who now live in newness of life that can meet these standards.

There are a few of such people in Nigeria today and they are can be found across ethnic, religious, sectional and geographical barriers. They are found among Igbos, Hausas, Yorubas, and others; They are found among Christians, Muslims and traditional religions. They are in the North as

well as in the South, East and West of this country. Whereas they were all blind before, now they can see (John 9:25), and it is only by their fruits that you shall know them (Matt 7:16, 20). They have all been regenerated, their old nature having been transformed; if they stole before, they now steal no more (Eph 4:28); old things in their lives are passed away, and behold all things are become new (2 Cor 5:17).

Not every Christian has this new life but there are few in this country. I have also seen some Muslims receive this new life; and some in the traditional religion who never believed in the Living God, nor worshipped anything, have recently received this new life. it is only within the circle of those who manifest the fruit of this new life (the fruit of love, joy, peace, patient, gentleness, self control, goodness, kindness, faith, meekness) it is only from a small circle of such people that we can begin and end our search for righteous and responsible leadership. Outside this class of people there can be none.

9

GOVERNMENT'S 'NEW-BREED' POLITICIANS

This nation has been ruled since independence, at different times, by few (if any), who could describe themselves as righteous and responsible within the meaning of our definition in this book. And that is why the nation has made little progress because it is righteousness which exalts a nation but sin is a reproach to any people (Proverb 14:34).

If the Third Republic can succeed where the First and Second Republic failed, the rulership or leadership must not come from the same crop of people with "old nature". In other words, the so-called "new-breed" politicians must come from this circle of regenerated Nigerians who in world and indeed have forsaken their old sinful ways and life, and have now committed themselves to the life of fear of God, without compromises or excuses. This is the only way out as I can see it. We have tried every other things and failed. Let us therefore try the only thing we have not yet tried. I am not saying that this "might" work. Rather, I know that it is the only thing that will work.

The Government definition of "new-breed" as those who have never held a political post or those that have not been found guilty of any wrong doing is wrong, because every Nigerian is a sinner except those who have repented and rejected their old ways. A man does not become a saint because he stole and was not caught. if we allow the government's "new-breed" to run the affairs, the Third Republic shall fall faster than the First and Second.

I was interested in the comment credited to the former Anambra State Commissioner for Local Government and Chieftaincy Matters, Dr. A. B. Uzuakpunwa, in which he accused some of the new chairmen of local government areas of "deceiving the public." He "expressed fears about the future of this country when present day chairman would have gained higher office through foul means, he… noted that many of them (Chairmen) are only interested in what goes into their pocket even though several of their election promises have not been met" (National Concord, Monday, September 5, 1998, P.11). The Hon. Commissioner certainly was in a position to know what the chairmen did and his verdict was that he was "sorry" for this country. Yet the new chairmen were among the so-called "new-breed "politicians.

10

GOD'S
'NEW BREED' RULERS

I think we should stop deceiving ourselves and then tell ourselves the truth. it is the truth only that will set us free (John 8:32). The truth in this case is that it is only the righteous and responsible leaders as examined here that can be trusted to lead this nation out of the pit of political and uncertainty and economic dead-end.

Such righteous and responsible leaders are not only necessary at the Federal but also at the State levels. They are needed as the President of this country, as Board Chairmen and members, as Senators and House of Representatives, as Judges and Magistrates, as Lawyers, Professionals and Businessmen, and every man and woman, and every human being all across this nation so that things can begin to move in this country; so that we can humble ourselves and pray, and seek the face of God, and turn from our wicked ways so that God will hear from heaven, and will forgive our sin, and we heal our land (2 Chron. 7:14). This is the only hope I see. Apart from those who have repented of their past sins and now live in newness of life, any other leader you put up will be "business as usual",

they will devour the treasury; they will steal public money again, and the Third Republic will never last in their hand. We can try it and see.

And who can be this righteous and responsible leader? It is "anyone who leads a blameless life and is truly sincere. Anyone who refuses to slander others, does not listen to gossip, never harms his neighbour, speak out against sin, criticizes those committing it, (sin), commends the faithful followers of the Lord, keeps a promise even if it ruins him, does not crush his debtors with high interest rates, and refuses to testify against the innocent despite the bribes offered him-such a man shall stand firm forever. " (Psalm 15 LB).

11

CHRISTIANS WHO OPPOSE POLITICS

The grounds for such opposition includes the following:

- **THAT POLITICS IS WORLDLY AND EVIL**

There are some regenerated spirit filled Christians in Nigeria who have abstained from participating in elective politics, or even for serving in Government through appointments. They refuse to associate with the system which they see as corrupt and only fit for destruction. The political actors, according to them, are dishonest, selfish and corrupt. They steal public property and money; they lie and cheat; they show favoritism and nepotism. And to work in the same offices with such characters would be in contradiction to God's word that "evil communications corrupt good manners" (1 Cor. 15:33).

Such Christians argue that it is now part of the Nigerian system to give and receive bribe, either secretly or openly, in spite of all that have been done to check the evil by successive Governments through programmes such as WAI and MAMSER. They say that the case of bribery in Nigeria is so

bad that it poses very serious dilemma for some public servants. If such public offices receive bribe, they face the risk of exposure and perhaps disciplinary action. If they refuse to accept, they still face the risk of being eliminated through conspiracy of all the officers around them who may feel they are blocking their chance to get rich quick. Therefore, the problem with bribery in Nigeria is that if you receive there is trouble, if you refuse you have similar trouble. How then can a christian work in such an environment, they ask.

- **THAT POLITICS LEADS TO COMPROMISE IN THE LIFE OF A CHRISTIAN**

Some Christians reject political posts for fear that the time they would devote to God's work might be fettered by Government regulations and protocol. And Christians who occupy certain posts would be exposed to compromise their faith in order to discharge a duty of such an office. For example, a Christian President will be exposed to attend some non-Christian festivals or religious programmes to show he is the head of the whole nation, not a leader of the christians.

Similarly, a Christian governor, for example, in Anambra State, would be expected to attend the "Mmawu festival" which is a demonic activity, and would also be subjected to the entertainment of the nude women dancers which activity

is dubbed 'traditional' or 'customary'. On the Independence Day celebration service, he would also be expected to read the Lesson in one of the "dead churches" (Rev 3:1). The result is that by the time the Christian office- holder finishes his term, he would have been so polluted, and his faith so compromised that he would need to be "born-again" again. This is part of the view of those who are against Christian participation in politics.

- **THAT CHRISTIANS SHOULD RATHER PREPARE TO MEET THEIR SOON COMING KING**

The Christians who are opposed to involvement in politics quote the Lord who said, "Surely I come quickly" in Revelation 22:20. Such Christians would choose not to and entangle themselves with the things of this world, but rather to just wait for the imminent coming of the Lord as the Christians in Thessalonica did although St. Paul rebuked them telling them that" if any would not work, neither should he eat" (2 Thess 3:10).

- **THAT THE LORD'S KINGDOM IS NOT OF THIS WORLD**

Those Christians further argue that we are called to a life of separation from the world. That we are commanded not to be

"unequally yoked together with unbelievers: For what fellowship hath righteousness with unrighteousness?" and the what communication hath light with darkness... Wherefore come out from among them, and be ye separate, saith the Lord, and touch not the unclean things; and I will receive you" (2 Cor 6:14, 17).

Similarly, those Christians quote the Lord as saying that "my kingdom is not of this world"(John 18:36). And yet there are many Christians today who itch to rule and reign now as if their own kingdom is of this world, Observe the Christians against participation. They contend that Christians must agree with the Lord that our kingdom is not of this world, and that we must suffer now so that you might reign with him (2 Tim 2:12).

12

CHRISTIANS WHO FAVOUR POLITICS

- **THAT CHRISTIANS ARE IN THE WORLD BUT NOT OF THE WORLD.**

The Christians who advocate participation in politics buttress their position by citing the Lord's prayer in John 17:15 in which he said, "I pray not that thou shouldest take them out of this world, but that thou shouldest keep them from the evil." This means that although Christians are not of the world, there are nevertheless in the world.

Furthermore, the participating Christians points out St Paul's letter to the Corinthian Church in which he said, "I wrote unto you in an epistle not to company with fornicators. Yet not altogether with the fornicators of this world, or with the covetous, or extortioners, or with idolaters; for then must your needs go out of the world..." (2 Cor 5:9-10). This was part of an early letter St. Paul wrote them. But now he realized that by asking them not to have contact with the unbelievers, it means that Christians must be removed from the world, and this is not the way of God, as it would contradict the passage in John 17:15.

So, Paul wrote again and reversed the order as can be seen in 1 Cor 5:21, 13 where he said "if any man that is called a brother (or a Christian) be a fornicator, or covetous, or idolater, or a railer, or a drunkard, or an extortioner, with such an one know not to eat... put away from among yourselves that wicked person". I hope that the church denominations are reading and listening because many of the churches today are mere crusade grounds in which fornicators, the covetous, the idolaters, the railers, the drunkards and the extortioners gather together in fellowship; and they are not "put away" according to the Lord's command. Are these denominations therefore the Church of Christ since we know that the Church of Christ is without spots and wrinkle holy without blemish? (Eph 5:27).

Wheat and tares should not be allowed to grow together in the church; they can grow together only in the world (Matt 13:30). The Bible commands that the tares should be "put away" from the church if they ever appear there. Are the denominations obeying the Bible today since they welcome the tares to grow in the church? the tares in this case are the wicked people and the Bible says, "put them away from among yourselves" (1 Cor 5:13) The early church put away such people as in Acts 5:1-11.

- **RENDER TO CAESAR... AND TO GOD**

Some other Christians participate in politics relying and the word of the Lord in Mark 12:17 in which he said, "Render to Caesar the things that are Caesar's and to God the things that are God's." They therefore argue that God is not against rulership or participation in this world's governments as long as honour due Him is given to Him.

- **NO POWER BUT OF GOD.**

The participating Christians I also believe that they are backed up by Romans chapter 13 in which God commanded "every soul to be subject unto the higher powers. For there is no power but of God; the powers that be are ordained of God." Such Christians contend therefore that we are also called to "render to all their dues; tribute to whom tribute is due; custom to whom custom; fear to whom fear; honour to whom honour..."(Rom 13:1, 7-8). Because God said that he ordained all powers, such participating Christians feel it is their right and bounding duty to aspire to rule and to ascend to political power now, wherever and whenever possible.

- **HEIRS OF THE KINGDOM.**

Such Christians further contend that the Earth is the Lord's and the fullness thereof, the whole world and they that dwell therein (Psalm 24:1). They say that the unbelievers do not have any better claim or right than God's own children to rule he earth which is God's own property. And the Bible in Rom. 8:17, said that Christian are heirs of the Father and joint heirs with the Son, why then would Christians abandon their God given right to rule over God's Kingdom, such Christians ask. They also quote Genesis 1:28 and claim that God commanded them to "subdue" the world and to have "dominion" over every living thing which therefore gives them title to rule.

However, it is important to note that Christians are not heirs of this world, they are heirs of the Kingdom of God and this Kingdom is not yet here. So it would seem that if Christians must rule they should wait to rule in God's own Kingdom which God said it is His pleasure to give us (Luke 12:32).

- **TEACHING UNBELIEVERS HOW TO RULE.**

The Christians who want to rule now contend that since the unbelievers misrule and mismanage the affairs of the nation, that it is only proper that the christians should take over from

them to teach them the best way to rule in the knowledge and fear of God. But we must be careful in this view which has some element of "flesh" in it because we often mask "flesh" and make it appear "spiritual". But God alone knows our motive. We know that it is only when the Lord, our Messiah, shall come shall He rule in righteousness because the scepter of righteousness is the scepter of His Kingdom (Heb 1:8). However, there are Christians who believe they can usher in this righteous rule on earth before Christ comes. Can it be done? They nevertheless quote Psalm 110:1-2 as giving them authority to rule in the midst of their enemies now, not later.

- **FAITH WORKETH BY WORKS**

The participating Christians in politics agree with Apostle James in James 2:17,2, which says that "faith (or prayer) without works is dead, being alone". They say that Christians have been praying for good government and for those in power over these many years and yet nothing gets better. They now therefore feel that continuing to pray and having faith that things will be alright is no longer acceptable. They have decided therefore that now is the accepted time. Now is day of salvation (2 Cor 6:2) when Christians should rise up with one accord to take over the government of the nation on behalf of Christ.

But like other Christians I have reservations because such has

been tired before and God did not approve of it and the "take-over" movement failed (Acts 5:36-37). Anybody who now says that the Lord has decided to hand over to the christians the government of the nation must be able to show that he has paid the price of such rulership.

- **CHRISTIANS OR PHARAOHS.**

Furthermore, Christians interested in politics and government contend that it is because Christians have not to shown enough interest in rulership that God has raised up "Pharaohs" to punish the land (Rom 9:17). It is their view therefore that if more and more Christians get interested and involved in politics and occupy high positions, things would change. However, other Christians disagree and say that even if this happens, all they could see would be a few things getting better "here and there", and not that the kingdom of the devil would be dismantled " until He comes whose right it is", and God will give the government to Him (Ezekiel 21:27). It is only then that the kingdom of this world shall "become the kingdom of our Lord Jesus Christ; and He shall reign for ever and ever"(Rev. 11:15).

- **THE EXAMPLE OF DANIEL**

Christians who advocate participation in government cite the case of Daniel who choose to obey God rather than the King. Thus, after King Darius had signed the decree forbidding anyone in the Kingdom from worshipping any other God except the King's idol. What did Daniel do? He simply ignored the King's decree and "went into the house; and his windows being open in his chamber towards Jerusalem, he knelt down upon his knees three times a day, and prayed, and gave thanks before his God, as he did aforetime" (Daniel 6:10). This matter was brought to the attention of the King who commanded that Daniel be cast into the Lion's Den, saying unto him, " Thy God whom thou servest continually, he will deliver thee" (v. 16).

Daniel was saved because his hope was in his God. He told the story of his deliverance saying, "my God hath send his angel, and hath shut the lion's mouths, that they have not hurt me; forasmuch as before him innocence was found in me, and also before thee, O King, have I have done no harm'(v.22). The result of Daniel's rebellion against the King and his absolute obedience to God was what made the King make another decree commanding everyone in the dominion of his Kingdom to "tremble and fear before the God of Daniel for he is the living God, and steadfast forever, and his Kingdom that which shall not be destroyed" (v 26-27).

Many Christians today point out the triumph of Daniel without equally approaching that it was achieved at the risk of his life. How many Christians are ready to pay the price to stand for God whether it means death? God is not going to use any Christian who, like Daniel, is not prepared to forsake his life for the sake of the Kingdom. Christ said,"... whosoever he be of you that forsaketh not all that he hath, he cannot be my disciple" (Luke 14:33).

Many Christians would want to serve in government so that like Daniel, God could use them to bring glory to His name. But they forget that Daniel was a righteous instrument in the name of God, while many Christians today have their vessels so filthy that God cannot use them. For God to use us, we must first of all cleanse ourselves, purge, purify and sanctify ourselves; and "present our bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to God, which is our reasonable service. (Romans 12:1, 2 Cor 7:1; James 4:7-8; Romans 6:13).

- **THE EXAMPLE OF ESTHER**

The case of Esther shows clearly that it is God who places His people in strategic positions, whether in government or in the society at large. But it must be seen to be God doing it, not just our ego and fleshly interests pushing us along, and then we turn around and say, "it is God working", when he is not in it.

In the case of Esther, God raised her and placed her next to the King to use her to deliver the Jews from the evil plan of Haman. But Esther wavered and almost evaded responsibility. And listen to the warning with which she was warned: "Then Mordecai commanded to answer Esther, think not with thyself that thou shalt escape in the King's house, more than all the Jews. For if thou altogether holdest thy peace at this time, then shall there enlargement and deliverance arise to the Jews from another place; but thou and thy father's house shall be destroyed: AND WHO KNOWETH WHETHER THOU ART COME TO THE KINGDOM FOR SUCH A TIME AS THIS (Esther 4:13-24).

And what did Esther do? She went ahead to pay the price of purging and emptying herself so that God might use her. She commanded Mordecai saying, "Go gather together all the Jews that are present... and fast ye for me, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day I also and my maidens will fast

likewise, and so will I go in unto the King, which is not according to the law: AND IF I PERISH, I PERISH". (Esther 4:16).

We can see that Esther, like Daniel, threw away her life as she was set to do the will of God, and she said "if I perish, I perish". Esther forsook everything in line with Luke 14:33, and God used her mightily to deliver the Jews, and the name of the Lord was greatly magnified in the land. From that moment the Jews who were formerly persecuted became the centre of attention. Then the Jews had "light and gladness, and joy, and honour... And many of the people of the land became Jews, for the fear of the Jews fall upon them... and in the day that the enemies of the Jews hoped to have power over them... the Jews had rule over them that hated them... and no man could withstand them, for the fear of them fell upon all people" (Esther 8:27-17; 9:1-2).

Christians are looking forward to the day when our Redeemer, like Esther, shall come and turn the table for us and Christians will be feared in all the land, and we shall "rule over them that hate us, and no man can withstand us" for our fear shall fall upon all the nation. But this solution cannot come without sacrifice and without paying the price as Daniel and Esther did.

What is important is that one should know if and when God

has raised him, and such a person must confine himself to achieving the purpose for which he was raised. If God has not called you or raised you for political leadership, do not break your head in forcing your way through a closed door. For the door He opened no one can close it; and the door is closed none can open it (Rev. 3:7-8).

- **THE EXAMPLE OF SHADRACH, MESHACK AND ABEDNEGO**

In the case of the above three young Jews, they were accused of refusal to serve the King's gods or worship the golden image set up by Nebuchadnezzar. Whereupon the King summoned them and warned them saying, "now if ye be ready that at what time ye hear the sound of the cornet, flute, harp, psaltery, and all kinds of music, ye fall down and worship the image which I have made; but if ye worship not, ye shall be cast the same hour into the midst of a burning fiery furnace, AND WHO IS THAT GOD THAT SHALL DELIVER YOU OUT OF MY HANDS?" (Daniel 3:15).

The warning of the King clearly threatened fire and brimstone against these three young Jews as the King left them in no doubt that death to them would be the direct consequences of their continued "insubordination" as he saw their action. But the three prisoners could not be cowed. Rather they boldly

replied Nebuchadnezzar that they would not be "careful" in answering him, and then declared that, "if it be so, our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace, and he will deliver us out of thy hand, O King. BUT IF NOT, BE IT KNOWN UNTO THEE, O KING, THAT WE WILL NOT SERVE THY gods, nor worship the golden image which thou hast set up". (Daniel 3:16-18).

So, the battle line was drawn. the three Jews defied the King and his orders and stood solidly and confidently with the Lord God of Hosts; and they were saved. Even the King's messengers who threw the three men into the furnace of fire were burnt to ashes while the three Jews walked about in the midst of the fire without any scratch on their bodies; and above all they were joined by the Lord Himself, the SON OF GOD (verse 25). At last, another decree was made, "that every people, nation and language which speak anything amiss against the God of Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego shall be cut in pieces, and their houses shall be made dunghill; because there is no other God that can deliver after his sort". The King then promoted the three Jews in his domain (Verse 29-30). Praise God! "For promotion cometh neither from the east, nor from the west, nor from the south, but God is judge; he putteth down one, and setteth up another (Psalm).

- **THE EXAMPLE OF MOSES**

Moses was born to Hebrew parents in Egypt but he had the singular opportunity to be raised up in Pharaoh's house by the King's daughter. But the character of Moses was most attractive in terms of how he rejected the pleasures of Egypt and identified with the poverty and sufferings of children of God.

We are told that "by faith Moses when he was come to years, refused to be called the son of Pharaoh's daughter. Choosing rather to suffer affliction with the people of God, than to enjoy the pleasures of sin for a season; Esteeming the reproach of Christ greater than the treasures in Egypt...By faith Moses forsook Egypt, not fearing the wrath of the King; for he endured, as seeing him who is invisible" (Heb 11:24-27). How many Christians today in the so-called "corridors of power" can take such decisions as did Moses? Rather, what we get is a Christian in government changing his religion in order to get promotion in his post; or a Christian businessman changing his religion in order to win a contract. They fail to esteem the reproach of Christ greater riches than the treasurers of "Egypt". Unlike Moses, they compromise their faith and fear the wrath of the "King" because they have no vision of the Lord they profess to serve.

- **ESAU MENTALITY**

There is a growing tendency among many so-called christians to renounce their faith whenever there is material benefit accruing from such an action. Such people go to church to identify with highly placed top government officials like Ministers, Commissioners and Director-Generals. The purpose is to win contracts and get promotions or new appointments. But if they cannot get these things from Christian office holders, they would quickly register to go to Mecca, and on return, would put on the "Shagari" cap and a flowing white garment, and then become "Alhaji" (or " Alhaja" for women) for the purpose of winning same contract, or getting promotions or new appointments in government.

The Bible describes people like this as those whose God is their belly, or put differently, "their God is appetite" (Phil. 3:19 LB). Such people worship mammon, their appetite for material gains drives them into bribery and other corrupt practices (see "LAW & RELIGION IN NIGERIA" by Dr C.C. Mbadinuju, pp 6-7).

Such people are like Esau in his relationship with Jacob as contained in Genesis 24:29-33. In that story, Jacob was boiling pottage (lentil stew) one day, when Esau came from the field and was exhausted from the day's hunt. He was hungry. Esau said to Jacob, " I beg of you, let me have some of

the red lentil stew to eat for I am faint and famished". (That is why his name was called Ebom (Red stuff). Jacob answered, "Then sell me today your birthright -- the right of a first born" Esau said, "See here, I am at the point of death. What good can this birthright do me?" When a man is dying of starvation, what good is his birthright.

Then Jacob said, "swear to me today that you are selling it to me", and he swore to Jacob and sold him his birthright Thereupon, Jacob gave Esau bread, peas, and stew, and he ate and drink and went on about his business, indifferent to the loss of the rights he had thrown away (Amplified Bible, and LBT). Christians are therefore warned " lest there be any fornicator, or profane person, as Esau, who for one morsel of meat sold his birthright. For ye know how that afterward, when he would have inherited the blessing, he was rejected; for he found no place of repentance, though he sought it carefully with tears' (Hebrews 12:16-17).

So we see that the " Esau Mentality" disinherits Christians, and therefore like Moses, we must reject all the pleasures and treasures of " Egypt", and esteem the reproach of Christ greater than the " gifts" of Pharaoh.

- **THE LESSON**

Christians today who would like to serve in government so that God would use them to make better the conditions of all the Christians in our nation should first learn from Daniel, Esther, three young Jews, and Moses. These people refused to compromise anything in the worship of their God. They put their God first, and rebuffed every intimidation to make them worship gods which are no God at all.

But today we see the so-called Christians in government worship other gods. Some of them do not even know who their God is, they organize masquerades and extol the dead spirit of their ancestors. They are made chairmen of occasions in which unbelievers celebrate the new yam festival and things like that. How can our Holy God be honoured in such activities, and how can He use such filthy instruments who profess they know God but in works they deny Him? (Titus 1:16) God has not done it and will not do it. So, any Christian who aspires to rule and who hopes that God might use him, must first purge himself, and he must know the God he worships is a consuming fire (Heb 12:29). For those who know their God shall be strong, and do exploits (Daniel 11:32)

13

CAN A TRUE CHRISTIAN WIN IN NIGERIA?

The question of whether or not in Nigeria a true Christian or a righteous man can win an important election like the presidency or governorship and such other posts is pertinent. As we know, Nigeria is a democratic state and as such operates a system based on the will of majority

- **HURDLES**

Christianity is just one of the major religions in the country and Christians as a group are by no means in majority when compared with all other regions put together. But apart from the issue of democracy and they rule of majority, the country operates a two-party system as already approved for the Third Republic. A Christian who runs for an election must, therefore, first be nominated by any of the two political parties.

So, we already have two important hurdles which the Christian candidate must clear before he could win an election. He must be nominated by a party, and he must be

backed by majority of the electorate. The other hurdles he must also clear include the problem of financial support, public endorsement, his standing in the society his image and background, his views on issues in the election, and other factors such as these.

Given the practice of patronage, bribery, favoritism based on tribe and religion, statism and sectionalism that feature during nominations and elections in this country, what will the Christian do? The non-christians will surely operate on the basis of "might is right" and "the end justified the means. "What will the Christian do?"

- **WHO IS A CHRISTIAN?**

So far, I have used the term" Christian" and also "true Christian" and therefore there is need for some explanation. Actually, there should be nothing like "true Christian." It is either one is a Christian, or one is not. but I use "true Christian" to show that most people who parade themselves as Christians are fake, counterfeit, not genuine. A Christian is one who is like Jesus Christ in his character, the words he speaks and how he spoke it, in his thought and in his actions. A Christian is one who loves God above every other thing in this life and who loves his neighbor as himself (Mark 12:30-31). He is somebody who manifests the fruit of the Spirit,

which is love, joy, peace, gentleness, self-control, faith, goodness, kindness, patience, or long-suffering, and meekness (Gal 5:22).

What we have described is the character of Christ and the character of Christian (Acts 4:13; 11:2). So, when I say true Christian, I actually mean a Christian as described here. If you do not see yourself within this description, then you are outside it- you are not a Christian at all! Those who go to church and smoke, and drink alcohol, cheat, lie, steal, forge, bribe, fornicate, who are otherwise immoral in thought, word or deed are not "Christ-like", and therefore not Christians. If such " Christ-less" persons are elected or chosen leaders in this country we cannot say that we have Christians as leaders, neither can we say that we have a righteous leadership. Great majority of those who attend churches today are not Christians within the definition, and the Bible even says that there are only few who will find eternal life (Matt 7:14).

In my book on "Law and Religion in Nigeria", I said among other things that "a Christian is not one who attends a church, and is baptized, confirmed, takes holy communion, marries in the church, and contributes towards the work of the church. The man Cornelius in Acts chapter 10 was said to be a devout man who prayed three times a day with his family; he gives alms, he feared God, and received a "good report

among all the nation of the Jews." But he was not saved despite all his good works and good moral foundation. All our works are like filthy rags before God (Isa. 64:6). But His salvation came when Peter spoke to him about Jesus Christ, and he believed the gospel. The Lord baptized him.

God has provided steps through which a man can be a Christian. The Lord said: "Except a man be born again, he cannot see or enter the kingdom of God" (John 3:3, 5, 7). So, the following are the steps:

- Hear the Word of God (Rom 10:17)
- Repent of your sins and be baptized (Acts 2:38)
- Call upon the name of Jesus (Acts 2:21)
- Forsake your sins (2 Tim 2:19)
- Confess Jesus with your mouth and
- Believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead (Rom. 10:9). (For further Reading, see "False Men & True Christian" by Dr C.C. Mbadinuju -- A Christian Centre Publication, 22 Oguta Road, Onitsha).

And You know that you are a Christian:

- If you do not argue against the Bible, but rather accept every word in the Bible as the word of God, and live by it (Matt 4:4).
- If you place all your faith in God (Job 13:15).
- If you accept Jesus Christ as your Lord and your God (John 20:28).

- If you witness or preach to others about Jesus Christ as your Lord and personal saviour (Matt. 28:19; Acts 1:8).
- If you cannot sincerely and truthfully adhere to all the above, then you are not yet a Christian. You must be Born-Again. (For further Reading, see " Living by Every Word of God" by Dr. C.C. Mbadinuju -- a Christian Centre Publication, 22 Oguta Road, Onitsha."

So, a Christian, by definition is one who is regenerated, having confessed his sins and forsaken them. He is a new creature, old things are passed away, behold all things are become new (2 Cor 5:7). As we examined earlier, he is righteous, holy, leads a blameless life, and is truly sincerely; he refused to slander others and does not listen to gossip. He never harms his neighbor; he speaks out against sin and criticizes those who commit sin. He keeps his promise even if it ruins him and he does not crush his debtors with high interest rates and refuses to testify against innocent despite the bribes offered him (see Psalm 15 LB).

From the start of the election process, one can see that the Christian is handicapped because he cannot " wheel and deal" as his opponents. I cannot remember any election in Nigeria so far which did not feature bribery and corruption, rigging, stealing votes. burning of ballot papers and polling booths

destruction of ballot papers with acid, kidnapping of opponents, murder, announcement of wrong results, and declaring the loser a winner, and vice versa. No Christian can take part in any of these anomalies because they are sins against God. Yet we know that in Nigeria if any candidate does not engage in these sinful practices, he would likely lose the election.

- **CORRUPT SYSTEM**

So how can the righteous Christian win in this corrupt system? The election time in Nigeria has always been seen by the voter as a time of personal enrichment. The villagers would tell the candidate that they would vote only for the highest bidder. There are also the "King makers" who say they are like "beautiful bride" meaning that they would only be espoused to the candidate who offers them the highest "bride price". It is almost an impossibility to campaign in Nigeria without paying through your nose. Not only will you give bribe, but you must also buy drinks like beer, hot liquor, cigarettes and things like that. If the candidate says that he is a Christian and that he would not play the game according to this rule, he will fail to obtain majority.

Getting the votes, you need to win election in Nigeria is like "buying and selling" in a market. And as Dr. K.O. Mbadiwe

once said, "if you want greatness, you must finance it." This properly explains the disposition of the average Nigerian. If you want the votes, you buy them. If, however you say you are a Christian and you will not buy the votes, others will be more than willing to buy your shares. And so, what would the Christian do? Would he compromise and buy the vote? Or would he stand on what his Bible says? There is the story of a Christian, who in the last local government elections, contested for a counsellor's seat. Some people in his Ward knew him as a Christian who never drank alcohol nor gave to others to drink. The opposing candidate, a churchgoer, gave beer and other alcoholic drinks to the voters and therefore many young people gathered in his house, and helped him day and night in his campaign.

When the Christian sensed what was going on he knew that if he did nothing, he would surely lose for want of support. So, one evening he bought some cartons of beer and began to go round his Ward to offer them to voters. But he got the shock of his life. The voters refused to accept the beer. They challenged him to explain why he would offer them what he himself had all along condemned. They not only refused to accept the alcoholic drinks, but they also refused to vote for him for his hypocrisy. Before the elections, the Christian candidate saw the handwriting on the wall and withdrew from the race.

- **SERVING GOD AND MAMMON**

Our Christian brother in this story presents a pathetic picture. He wanted to serve God and mammon, and ended up joining the unbelievers since he could not win against them. But suppose the Christian candidate had resolved to win the election by all means, believing that what is important is being a Christian counsellor, believing that God would use him to help Christians, and that what he did to win would not matter very much?

Supposing he offers bribe to the "King makers" buys over many voters to his side. Although he himself did not drink beer, but he offered it to the voter that they might vote for him (Habakkuk 2:15). Supposing at the end he wins the election, would he still claim he is a Christian? He cannot be, because he had dishonoured God, if you win an election through stealing, cheating, rigging, and through other immoral and dishonest means you lose with God. You cannot eat your cake and have it. You cannot serve God and mammon.

And suppose the Christian candidate commissions some people to run his campaign. He tells them: "I will close my eyes to anything you want to do to make sure I win the election. You can rig, you can offer bribe, you can buy over all

the voters, you commit thuggery, and intimidate the opponent, and kidnap him if need be, in order to pave the way for my victory. Just make sure I win by all means, and I will pay you any amount you need to finance the campaign. What is important is that I will not be personally involved in the whole exercise because you know I am a Christian". Will God honour such an arrangement? Of course, not. The Christian will at once be a partaker in the sin of those other people (1 Tim 5:22; Rom 1:32). The sin they commit was on behalf of the candidate. He used the other people as an instrument to commit sin.

It is the same if a Christian decides not to contest for any seat or any post because he might fall into the sin of rigging, or cheating, or stealing votes in the election. He therefore rejects any involvement. If the party nominated him, for example, to contest for a seat in the House of Representatives, he would turn it down and would assure everyone that he would support the party financially and otherwise. But that if the party won, he would prefer to be appointed a State Commissioner, or a Board Chairman, because as a Christian he would not want to be involved in the corrupt electoral process. He would therefore wait to reap the result got from stealing and other immoral methods.

In a case like this, the Christian would want other people to do the dirty work for him, without realizing that the post he would occupy at the end would still be tinted with the same corruption and immorality. God still would not be honoured. God cannot in anything, and at any time, validate gains gotten fraudulently or illegally. Such gains would remain an abomination unto Him. So, we can see that the Christian who runs his political campaign on the conventional rules as we know them today can still win the election, but he could no longer continue to lay claim to being a child of God. He would have lost his standing with God by the time he had finished with and won the election.

We have seen a Christian candidate withdraw from a local government council ward election because he could not go ahead to win it. But suppose in that Ward, there were more numbers of Christians? Could the Christian candidate win? He might, depending upon the voters' level of education and commitment to God, as well as their economic interests. If the opponent brought a lot of money to try to buy their voters, anything could happen, and an apparent winner might become a sore loser over-night. It has happened several times before.

- **FINANCING THE ELECTIONS**

How then can we get the righteous and responsible leaders to rule if they cannot win in the election? If a Christian loses in a local election because he could not offer bribe and rig the election, and treat the voters with beer parties and so on, what is the hope that such righteous and responsible leadership can emerge at the state or national level?

At the state or national level, campaign and elections would require a lot of money because there would be wider areas to be covered; and transportation, security, and other logistics would be costly too. Even if the Christian candidate has money personally, he must surely need help from others. But his problem would be that in campaign he would speak against bribery, nepotism, inflating contact sums, and 10 per cent charge on contacts, and all other forms of corruption and malpractices. How then will he find people to finance his campaign?

Most people finance candidates in elections as a kind of investment. When the candidate wins, the financiers will get their returns through inflated contracts, mobilization fee paid for work not done, and the other acts of corruption which the Christian candidate had condemned in his campaign. So, we see that the Christian candidate will receive little or no

support in his campaign from the wealthy class because he is opposed to their method. And although what he says would appeal to more voters of the lower- and middle-class categories, yet they would not vote for him because their votes would have been bought by the opponent and witchcraft spell cast upon them should they change their mind.

- **ANY HOPE?**

So, we see how, in our present system, the righteous and responsible man could not easily be a leader because he could not possibly win in the election whose rules and practices operate against the laws and commandments of God. Is there any hope them? **Yes**, the Christian's hope is not in man, or in the human system, but in God himself. There could still be miracle in which a righteous and responsible Nigerian is elected President of the country and state governors, and members of the Senate and House of Representatives. Christians can win but it will take miracle from God to do so, given the present circumstances of our electoral laws and practices.

14

NEW WINE IN OLD BOTTLES

When we recommend righteous and responsible leadership for this country, what leadership positions are within contemplation? Is it enough that we should have the President of this nation as a righteous and responsible leader? Can the system work if the President alone is righteous and responsible and no else? Is it not required that for there to be a meaningful change in this country, that not only the President, but his Cabinet, the State Governors and their Commissioners should also be righteous and responsible.

And how about the Directors-General (the former Permanent Secretaries); how about the Chairmen and members of Board of Government Companies and Commissions, how about the Judges, Magistrates and Lawyers who dispense justice? How about every professional and businessman in the land, how about every man and every woman in whatever capacity? Should not everyone of these be required to be righteous and responsible in whatever calling and in whatever leadership position each finds himself or herself?

- **NEW SYSTEM**

Unless our whole system of doing things is overhauled, the righteous and responsible leadership, if we are to get it, will be immobilized; and cannot function because it would be like putting new wine in old bottles. The Lord said in Matthew 9:16-17, " No man putteth a piece of new cloth unto an old garment, for that which is put in to fill it up taketh from the garment, and the rent is made worse. Neither do men put new wine into old bottles, else the bottles break, and the wine runneth out, and the bottles perish: But they put new wine into new bottles, and both are preserved."

The only way, therefore, in which the new crop of righteous and responsible leadership could survive is if there is a corresponding new system: a new political system, a new social system, a new judicial system or a new system of dispensing justice. Things could work in this country only if "Old things are passed away, and all things are become new" (2 Cor 5:17). And this change must happen in the life of individuals as well as in the life of the social. political, and economic institutions of this nation.

- **NEW POLICY DIRECTION**

Our country is not moving, and when it moves, it moves in the wrong direction. Everything we do as a nation, we do it contrary to the Word of God. God promised He will forgive us our sins in this nation and heal our land. But we must first humble ourselves, and pray, and seek the face of God, and turn from our wicked ways. Then will God hear from heaven (2 Chron. 7:14). We have not done what God said, and yet we expect that he will heal our land. It is not just possible.

Secondly, God said that nations which pray to Him for blessings and prosperity must first bless Israel. He said of Israel:" I will bless them that bless thee and curse him that curseth thee. In thee shall all the families of the earth be blessed" (Gen. 12:3). We are also enjoined to "pray for the peace of Jerusalem: They shall prosper that love thee" (Psalm 122:6). The Bible further says that, "for the nations and kingdoms that will not serve thee shall perish. Yea, those nations shall be utterly wasted" (Isa 60:12).

But what do we do in this country? We hate Israel and refuse to recognize her sovereignty. Thus, we fight against God, and declare God our enemy. But we still pray to God to prosper us and to heal our land. Can it be done? Let us learn as a nation to do first things first, and we will see that the Lord is good. Even

Egypt in whose sympathy we broke relations with Israel has since re-established diplomatic relations with Israel. But here in Nigeria it is "business as usual" That cannot save us.

In my last book on "Israel... a Foreign Relations Guide to Foreign Policy" I ended the book with the following warning: " Let us remember that God is a consuming fire and He is not a respecter of persons (Rom 2:11) or nations. God only watches over his Word to perform it (Jere 1:12). What he says He will do; He will do it. Whether you believe what God said or not will make no difference. Hath, He said, and shall He not do it? or hath He spoken, and shall He not make it good? (Numbers 23:19). I am constrained also to end this book on the same note.

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CONCLUSION

It is important that this nation as a people return to God, and those who profess themselves as followers of the Lord Jesus Christ should stop living their lives in compromises because as between the Lord and the devil, there will never be reconciliation. Although the whole nation needs a facelift, but all our efforts will be doomed to failure until we find the right leadership – the righteous leadership that hears from God and takes directions from above; a leadership that will lead this nation in the paths of righteousness, peace, and prosperity, a leadership that is just, upright, godly, virtuous, good, honest, equitable, blameless, pious, pure, guiltless; a Leadership that is accountable, liable, answerable, trusted, able, ready, willing, in short, a righteous and responsible leadership. This should remain the goal and hope of this country.

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